

ARSENAL V LEEDS

Coach brief for Arsenal. EPL gameweek 6, Sat 10 Oct 11:30.

Arsenal should have the ball. The biggest mismatch is Arsenal's press against Leeds' build-up, which copes with pressure worse than 80% of clubs. Leeds have no matching opening on the team numbers; their usual route is set pieces.

Model: Arsenal win 55%, draw 25%, Leeds win 20%. Expected goals 1.7 v 0.9. An estimate from results and chance quality, not a tip.



THE THREE DUELS THAT MATTER MOST

- 1. Saka v Gudmundsson: leans to Saka**
Get Saka one against one with Gudmundsson early and keep going back to it.
- 2. Okafor v Konsa: leans to Konsa**
The numbers lean towards Konsa: he can go tight to Okafor and compete for the first ball, so the line can hold higher.
- 3. Ødegaard v Tanaka: leans to Ødegaard**
Look for Ødegaard between the lines early: his creating outranks Tanaka's ball-winning, so the game may tilt here.

Blue = an edge for Arsenal, orange = a threat. A tilt is where the game may lean, not a forecast.

ARSENAL: OUR THREE LINES

- PRESS THEM**
Press their build-up; they give it away.
Backtest: this kind of advice held up last season.
- LOAD THE BOX**
Set pieces are a route to goal; load the box.
Backtest: unproven: no better than the baseline last season.
- ATTACK THEIR LEFT**
Attack their left (your right): entries there end in a shot more often, and Gabriel Gudmundsson is the target

WHAT LEEDS WILL TRY

- LOAD THE BOX**
Set pieces are a route to goal; load the box.
Backtest: unproven: no better than the baseline last season.
- ATTACK THEIR LEFT**
Attack their left (your right): entries there end in a shot more often, and Myles Lewis-Skelly is the target
- COMMIT FORWARD**
Attack with numbers; they rarely counter.

OUR SET PIECES Aim at the central six-yard box, flood the flick-on and the loose ball, isolate Ethan Ampadu in the air.

THEIR SET PIECES Put your best header on Jaka Bijol, expect out-swingers to the penalty spot, stay switched on for the second ball.

REFEREE Not appointed yet. With an average official expect about 25 fouls and 4.3 yellow cards. Likeliest bookings: Tzolis, Calafiori, Ampadu, Bogle.

SCHEDULE Arsenal 21 days' rest, Leeds 20 (Arsenal +1). No fatigue call: no real rest gap.

STAFF NOTES